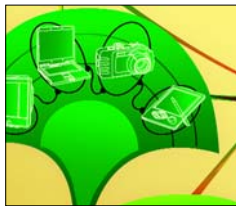
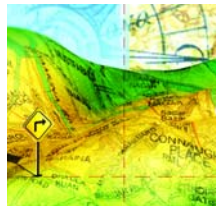




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Digital Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Lead Feature

The Attack Of the Mobile Gamers

The mobile gaming boom is upon us. Here's how India is gearing up

Aditya Kuber

Mobile phone users in India grew to almost 50 million in 2004, and now outnumber landline users in the country. While this has opened the doors to many allied industries, mobile gaming is being seen as the next big thing. And why not: in 2004 itself, the mobile gaming industry is said to have been worth \$26 million (Rs 113 crore), and is believed to have the potential to grow to a massive \$336 million (Rs 1,460 crore) by 2009. Given the numbers, activity in this industry is currently hectic, and all the major players want to carve out a niche for themselves before the big bang!

Big Business

Even now, the numbers are not small, given the size of the market. It is believed that almost six to seven lakh games are downloaded daily across India. "Ringtones are the current leaders in downloads by mobile users, but games are catching up slowly," says Rajiv

Hiranandani, country head, Mobile2Win.com.

As has happened with other IT services, India may soon find itself the preferred destination for creating games as well. Given the



Illustration Shyam Sriram

